Pouch Sealing Machine



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Hand Sealer/Pouch Sealer; Sealing Machine

What it is used for

A pouch sealing machine seals compatible packaging film or pouches using heat, pressure, or another specified sealing method. Correct temperature, dwell time, pressure, and hygienic handling help produce consistent seals and protect the packaged product.

Main parts

- Heating element produces sealing heat where fitted.
- Sealing jaws or bars press the pouch closure area.
- Temperature controller sets the sealing temperature on heated models.
- Timer controls the sealing duration where fitted.
- Pressure handle or pneumatic mechanism applies sealing pressure.
- Work surface supports the pouch during sealing.
- Power switch starts and stops the machine.
- Indicator lights show heating or operating status.

Before you start

1. Only trained personnel should operate the pouch sealer.
2. Read the manual and confirm the machine is suitable for the pouch material and product.
3. Inspect the power cable, plug, sealing jaws, heating surface, handle, and controls for damage.
4. Check that the temperature, pressure, and sealing time settings match the packaging material instructions.
5. Clean the work surface and sealing area using the approved hygiene procedure.
6. Keep flammable materials away and ensure the machine is placed on a stable, heat-resistant surface.
7. Confirm that the sealing area is free of product residue, moisture, and foreign material.

How to use

1. Switch on the machine and allow the sealing element to reach the specified operating temperature where applicable.
2. Set the sealing temperature, dwell time, and pressure according to the pouch material and product requirements.
3. Prepare the pouch and ensure the sealing edge is clean, dry, and free of product.
4. Place the pouch edge flat between the sealing jaws or at the designated sealing position.
5. Activate the sealing cycle using the approved handle, switch, or control.

6. Maintain the pouch in position for the specified dwell time without touching the hot sealing surface.
7. Release the handle or control and remove the pouch once the sealing jaws have opened safely.
8. Inspect the seal for continuity, wrinkles, gaps, burn-through, or contamination.
9. Adjust settings only within the manufacturer's limits if the seal quality is unsuitable.
10. Switch off the machine after use and allow hot parts to cool before cleaning.
11. Clean the sealing area, record any faults, and store the machine safely.

⚠ Safety

- Do not touch the heated sealing bar or jaws during operation or while they remain hot.
- Keep fingers away from closing jaws and pinch points.
- Do not use the machine with damaged wiring, exposed heating elements, or faulty controls.
- Do not seal containers or materials that may release hazardous fumes when heated.
- Keep water and wet hands away from electrical components.
- Isolate power before cleaning, maintenance, or removing jammed packaging.

Care & storage

- Remove packaging residue from the sealing area after the machine has cooled.
- Clean food-contact or product-contact surfaces using approved methods where applicable.
- Inspect sealing jaws, heating surfaces, handles, cables, and controls regularly.
- Arrange authorised maintenance if temperature control, timing, or sealing pressure becomes unreliable.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using settings that are unsuitable for the pouch material.
- Sealing over product residue, moisture, or wrinkles.
- Touching hot sealing jaws or placing fingers in pinch points.
- Cleaning or clearing packaging while the machine remains powered.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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